

SLOPEWATCH · DESIGN DECISION RECORD

SlopeWatch TRL 2 review decisions

Open Hardware Portfolio · amishchadha.com

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	SLW-DDR-001	Version	0.1
Status	Draft	Date	2026-09-25
Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/slopewatch		
Source	docs/decisions/0001-trl2-review-decisions.md @ f01ab14		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Record the TRL 2 review items adopted as recommended for TRL 3 work, and the items that remain open

0001: TRL 2 review decisions

- **Date:** 2026-09-25
- **Status:** proposed. Items D1 to D7 are adopted as recommended for TRL 3 work, pending Amish's review; items O1 to O3 remain "Proposed, awaiting Amish".

■ Context

The TRL 2 review note (docs/REVIEW.md , session 2026-09-25, /populate) listed nine items as "Proposed, awaiting Amish", and the design precis SLW-PRC-001 v0.2 listed the key design choices, most with options and a recommendation. On 2026-09-25 Amish asked for this batch of repos to be taken through the usual process with the instruction "you know the drill, nothing gets past TRL 3". He has not reviewed this repo's items one by one. Every item that carried a recommendation is therefore adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review. Items without a recommendation stay open. Nothing in this record is a decision by Amish.

■ Options considered

The options for each item are those listed in docs/REVIEW.md (session 2026-09-25, /populate) and in SLW-PRC-001 v0.2, Key design choices.

■ Decision

Table 1. Items adopted for TRL 3 work.

#	Item	Recommendation adopted	Status
D1	Budget (TRL 2 item 1)	Option B: the FieldNode core is costed in the FieldNode project, as SunSpoke does with the SwapCell pack, and an existing pole replaces the mast where one exists. The \$250 <code>budget_usd</code> covers the SlopeWatch-specific parts of one reference site. <code>budget_usd</code> is unchanged; no new figure was recommended. R11 is redefined accordingly in SLW-REQ-001 v0.3.	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D2	Tailings dams in the pitch (item 2)	Keep them, with the limits stated in every document: a supplementary layer only, installed with the owner's and engineer of record's permission, and no claim to detect brittle failure. The pitch is unchanged, since no rewording was recommended.	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D3	Sensing method (item 3)	Surface tilt stakes plus one crack gauge, rather than borehole inclinometers or GNSS.	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D4	Bus (item 4)	A wired RS-485 bus to one FieldNode for the prototype; wireless stakes recorded as a later variant.	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D5	Inclinometer (item 5)	Murata SCL3300, with an ADXL355-class accelerometer as the fallback. SLW-CAL-001 adds that the sensor must run in its mode 1 (± 90 degrees), because its inclination modes 3 and 4 stop at ± 10 degrees.	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D6	Alert rules (item 6)	The published 0.01 and 0.1 degrees per hour tilt-rate thresholds as defaults, site values set by an engineer after a baseline period; warning on one stake confirmed on two consecutive readings; keyed 30 min silence that re-arms.	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D7	Alert unit location (item 7)	On the mast at the toe for the prototype; a second unit near the work face or in the village, linked by LoRa, as an option after co-design.	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review

Table 2. Items that remain open.

#	Item	Status
O1	The <code>problem</code> wording change in <code>project.yaml</code> ("often give warning") made at TRL 2 (item 8). The TRL 2 note offered "accept or revert" without a recommendation, so the wording stays as it is and the choice stays with Amish.	Proposed, awaiting Amish
O2	First co-design partner and site type (item 9): an artisanal mining cooperative, a quarry, or a hillside community with a district disaster office. No preference was stated.	Proposed, awaiting Amish
O3	Crack-gauge thresholds (1 mm per day and 1 mm per hour are placeholders), to be set per site with a geotechnical partner. No recommendation was made. SLW-CAL-001 adds that the precaution rate must be taken over 24 h (see Consequences).	Proposed, awaiting Amish

■ Consequences

- `project.yaml`: `budget_usd` stays \$250, and the pitch and problem lines are unchanged. Only the TRL fields and evidence list change.
- SLW-PRB-001, SLW-PRC-001 and SLW-REQ-001 are revised to v0.3. The key design choices in the precis are no longer described as "proposed"; they are adopted for TRL 3 work pending Amish's review. R11 now reads "SlopeWatch-specific parts for one reference site, \$250 or less, excluding the FieldNode core and any gateway".
- The calculations in SLW-CAL-001 led to four changes within these choices: the capsule sits 0.4 m deep instead of 0.3 m (R2), with foam plugs above and below it; the crack gauge gets its own RS-485 reader (+\$6), since it is about 60 m of cable from the node; the precaution beacon flashes at 1 % duty or less (R8); and the crack-gauge precaution rate is taken over 24 h, so the gauge's own daily thermal swing does not trip it.
- R11 is still not met with a new mast (\$261 against \$250); it is met where an existing pole is used (\$237). No new budget is proposed here; the options are in `docs/REVIEW.md`.
- TRL 4 is on hold by Amish's instruction. Nothing in this record authorizes building or testing.